

US Tariff Impact Tracker: Imports into LA Mixed Over Next Two Weeks

US Tariff Impact Tracker: This past week, laden vessels from China to USA were down sequentially (-19% WoW) and down on a YoY basis (-25.5% YoY). Data suggests TEUs coming into Port of LA will turn positive next week (+3% WoW) following this past week's -6% sequential move, before seeing a decrease of -7% WoW two weeks out (YoY is expected to be -7% and then unchanged, one week and two weeks out). What we will need to monitor is how levels move through July, which could suggest how shippers are deciding to restock, how early peak could be starting (and whether there was an early start to peak shipping this spring), and with in some cases how lower effective tariff rates impact import decisions amidst an uncertain geopolitical backdrop.

Trade uncertainty remains prevalent in global trade, especially following the recent Supreme Court ruling and the subsequent announcement from the administration for new tariffs under Sec. 122 (see our macro team's [assessment](#)). We believe that the uncertainty may have two near- to medium-term impacts on global freight. First, given that trade uncertainty has risen and the administration has not disclosed how it will proceed after the Sec. 122 tariffs expire in 150 days, this may impact medium- to longer-term freight planning. Second, a more near-term impact will be countries that now have a lower effective tariff rate may pick up exports into the U.S. We note that this may take time to show up in the data, particularly for freight out of mainland China as manufacturing and shipping pick back up following a later than usual LNY.

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Key observations from this past week's report:

- **China freight flows (week ending Thursday, July 16th) showed a sequential decline in laden vessels from China to the US (-19%) with a negative YoY at -25.5% (vs -10% in the prior week).**
- **Port Optimizer sequentials indicate imports into the Port of Los Angeles are set to be up +3% TEUs (July 24) while the early read suggests a decrease of -7% on a two-week out basis;** on a YoY basis, imports into LA are set to trend negative to -7% and then remain unchanged two-week out.
- **Rail intermodal volumes along the West Coast were +4% YoY following last week's +13% performance.**
- **Ocean container rates were down -6% sequentially; rates on a YoY basis were up +204% YoY this past week.** We anticipate some choppiness could remain over the coming weeks as global capacity potentially shifts given ongoing geopolitical events.
- **Load availability for trucks on the West Coast increased last week sequentially (+25%) and was positive on a YoY basis (+1%); truck spot rates on the West Coast were up +69% YoY ex-fuel.**

What the Tracker Is:

What We Disseminate Weekly: High frequency data to help assess the ongoing impact of tariffs on global supply chains and the accompanying ramifications on the flows of freight (e.g., expected ships leaving from China to USA). While we think our data set is representative, we do plan to periodically add new data series as they become available.

It is important to recognize that weekly data can be volatile, with a fair bit of noise depending on timing—but we still think looking at the data collectively, and perhaps over a multi-week basis can be informative as to tariff-related trends.

2026 Trade and Transport Scenario Roadmap—Revised From First and Second Edition:

As we moved past the 2025 homestretch and into 2026, the ability to find a profit and earnings bottom and eventually see an earnings upgrade cycle comes down to one thing: volume growth, with an appropriate weighting towards higher margin business-to-business, commercial and/or manufacturing flows. Recent improved share price performance from the trucking sector could perhaps be tied to the notion that volumes (and in terms of truckload - supply) could indeed be at a more stable point with which improvement could come from at some point in 2026.

Ramifications from tariff-related uncertainty that caused pull-forward in demand—bracketed by shipper indecision as to how much product to manufacture and/or order for inventory—had been a culprit behind transports broad underperformance for much of 2025 and tied directly into our view that we may see subseasonal peak season shipping demand (for 4Q reporting).

That said, we remain positive on the cycle recovery story—despite the heretofore elusive bottom, and we note several factors that could finally stimulate a favorable and fulsome volume inflection into 2026 as we look to the medium to longer term.

- Fed rate cut cycles are typically beneficial to transport shares (see [Fed Rate Cuts and Transports](#)); GS economists predict one rate cut in 2026 (December) and another cut in March 2027 to add to the three cuts in 2025
- While tariff uncertainty still exists, we lapped Liberation Day on April 2, 2026—potentially yielding a more consistent playbook for shippers to work with and to plan.
- Various corporations are announcing increased investments in US manufacturing—including companies like Apple, Nvidia, IBM, Pfizer, Johnson & Johnson, etc.—which should auger-in more domestic freight flows.
- The bonus depreciation revival via the *One Big Beautiful Bill Act* could incentivize capital to reinvest in businesses.
- While tariff deployment is disruptive, any resulting re-shoring or nearshoring would bolster US manufacturing, which also should auger-in more domestic freight flows.
- Shifting logistics patterns and changing supply chain sourcing could drive secular global trade opportunity as companies potentially pursue a China Plus 1 or 2 strategy.

What to do with Transport stocks:

- We upgraded the truckers last year ([see our upgrade note](#)), as we believed the likelihood of recession had lessened, and as the consumer has stayed relatively resilient. While freight forwarders such as EXPD and CHRW could benefit from the volatility and surge in customs brokerage demand, we do note that YoY comparisons for ocean rates will be challenging. Should the Red Sea re-open, that could further add to effective capacity.
- **Other beneficiaries could be the parcels (UPS and FDX—both Buy-rated) with their fast cycle logistics and air freight as well as large global footprints that can help shippers shift supply chains.**

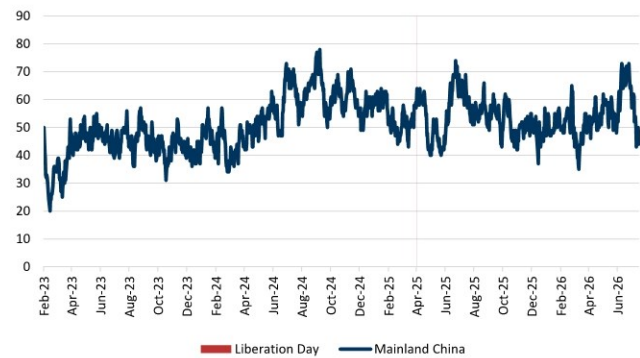
High Frequency Weekly Data

We track weekly (and some daily) data that helps provide as real time as possible insights into trade volumes, demand and pricing. We note that much of this data is choppy in the near term and more than often shows trends developing over time as we receive more data, but also speaks to the volatility of trade flows. Therefore, we caution against drawing conclusions week to week but note that it can be helpful to see changes in the data week to week given the dynamic trade environment. Below, we track the high frequency data points that we believe are highly relevant to trade and US freight transportation.

- **Laden container vessels from China to the US were -25.5% YoY over the last week (7/10-7/16) versus -10% YoY in the prior week (7/3-7/9). The sequential vessel decrease of -19% in the most recent week follows last decrease of -10%.**

Exhibit 1: Container ships to the US remain volatile; levels are nearing post-Liberation day increases

Daily Laden Container Ship Vessels from China to US

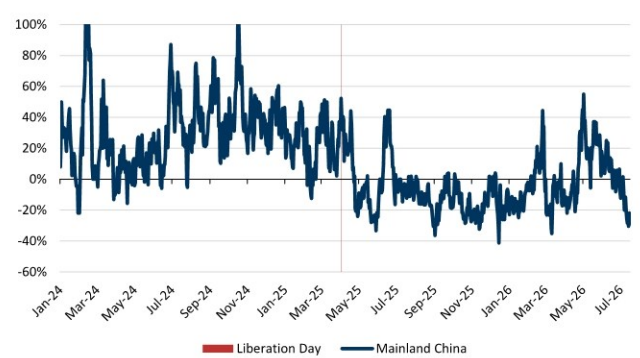


Data through 7/16/26 Captures the number of laden (i.e., cargo-carrying) container ships departing China en route to the US over a rolling 15-day window. Includes only vessels confirmed to be transporting cargo. Laden vessels are those reporting a draft of more than 75% of maximum draft at the start of their journey to the US. Note that data is subject to revisions.

Source: Bloomberg

Exhibit 2: Laden container ships from China to US have decelerated on a YoY basis in the most recent week

Daily Laden Container Ship Vessels from China to US, YoY



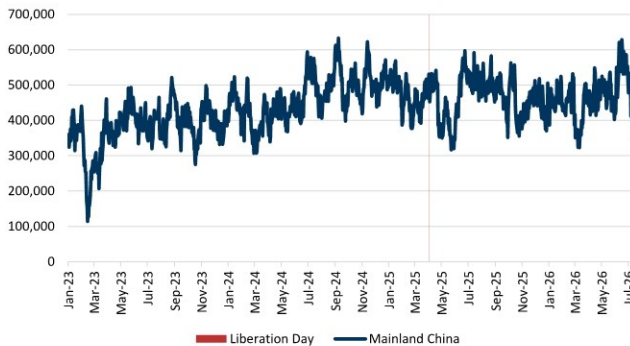
Data through 7/16/26 captures the number of laden (i.e., cargo-carrying) container ships departing China en route to the US over a rolling 15-day window. Includes only vessels confirmed to be transporting cargo. Laden vessels are those reporting a draft of more than 75% of maximum draft at the start of their journey to the US. Note that data is subject to revisions.

Source: Bloomberg

- **TEUs from China to the US were -26% YoY over the past week (7/10-7/16) versus -7% in the prior week (7/3-7/9). Sequentially, we saw a -18% YoY change in TEUs from Mainland China.**

Exhibit 3: TEUs have remained volatile

Daily TEU from China to the US

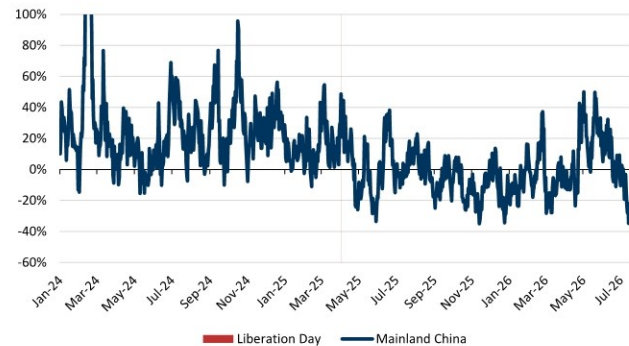


Data as of 7/16/2026. Represents the aggregated container volume, measured in twenty-foot equivalent units (TEU), of vessels departing China for the United States over a 15-day rolling period. Accounts for the shipping capacity being utilized, irrespective of the number of vessels. Dry cargo vessels leaving China are monitored as they exit Chinese waters. The dataset is filtered for vessels that have left over the 15 previous days and have reported the US as their country of destination. Note that data is subject to revisions.

Source: Bloomberg

Exhibit 4: TEU growth was decelerated in the most recent week

Daily TEU from China to the US, YoY



Data as of 7/16/2026. Represents the aggregated container volume, measured in twenty-foot equivalent units (TEU), of vessels departing China for the United States over a 15-day rolling period. Accounts for the shipping capacity being utilized, irrespective of the number of vessels. Dry cargo vessels leaving China are monitored as they exit Chinese waters. The dataset is filtered for vessels that have left over the 15 previous days and have reported the US as their country of destination. Note that data is subject to revisions.

Source: Bloomberg

Exhibit 5: Week 28 China to US vessels and TEUs were down WoW

Weekly Average TEUs and Vessels from China to US

Bloomberg China to US 6 Week Dashboard Weekly Average TEUs & Vessels							
Week	22	23	24	25	26	27	28
2026 Vessels	54	65	68	69	64	57	46
WoW		20.2%	4.6%	2.5%	-8.0%	-10.1%	-19.4%
2025 Vessels	50	58	64	70	65	64	62
2025 WoW		15.1%	11.7%	8.7%	-7.4%	-1.8%	-2.2%
2026 YoY	7.7%	12.4%	5.3%	-0.6%	-1.3%	-9.7%	-25.5%
2026 TEUs	448,568	537,355	581,875	557,474	536,168	476,766	389,719
WoW		19.8%	8.3%	-4.2%	-3.8%	-11.1%	-18.3%
2025 TEUs	398,319	459,259	532,618	559,219	525,660	510,667	524,435
2025 WoW		15.3%	16.0%	5.0%	-6.0%	-2.9%	2.7%
2026 YoY	12.6%	17.0%	9.2%	-0.3%	2.0%	-6.6%	-25.7%

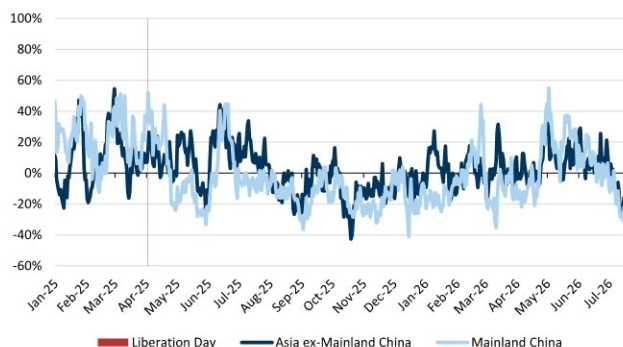
Week 28 7/10/2026-7/16/2026; Note that data is subject to revisions.

Source: Bloomberg

Mainland China's laden vessel and TEU growth vs. Asia Ex-Mainland China to US: On a laden vessel basis, Mainland China was down -26% YoY on average while Asia-Ex Mainland China was down -25% YoY. On a TEU basis, Mainland China was down -22% YoY on average while Asia-Ex Mainland was down -28% on average. We use the summation of Mainland China, Vietnam, South Korea, Taiwan and Japan as a proxy for Asia exports to the US.

Exhibit 6: Mainland China and Asia-Ex Mainland: vessels were down YoY for Mainland China and for Asia Ex Mainland China

Daily Laden Container Ship Vessels from Asia ex-Mainland China and Mainland China to US, YoY

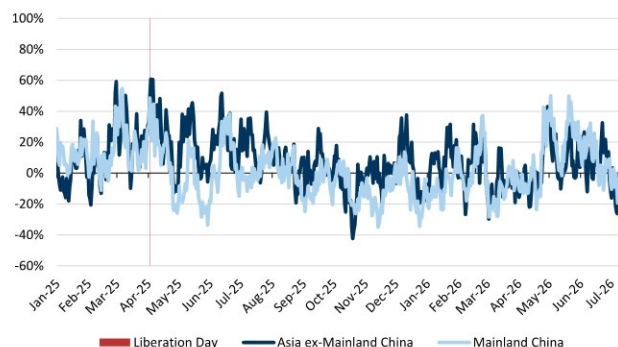


Asia ex-Mainland China includes Vietnam, South Korea, Taiwan, and Japan Data as of 7/16/2026

Source: Bloomberg

Exhibit 7: TEU growth from Mainland China and Asia-Ex Mainland China decelerated YoY this past week

Daily TEU from Asia ex-Mainland China and Mainland China to US, YoY



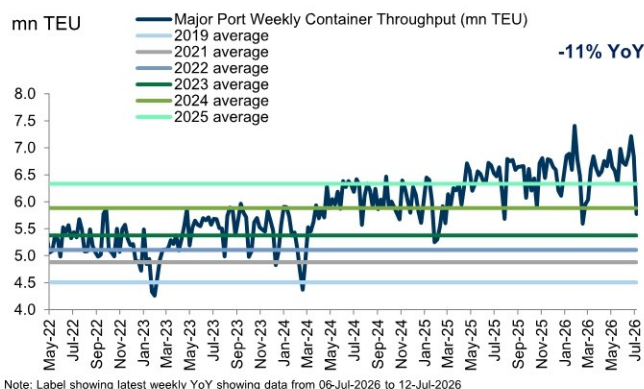
Asia ex-Mainland China includes Vietnam, South Korea, Taiwan and Japan Data as of 7/16/2026

Source: Bloomberg

- Chinese major port weekly throughput was down -15% w/w during the week ended 7/12 (latest available) after being down -5% w/w the prior week. **Throughput was -11% YoY vs +5% in the prior week.**

Exhibit 8: Chinese port activity was down -15% sequentially in the most recent week and down -11% YoY

Chinese major port weekly container throughput

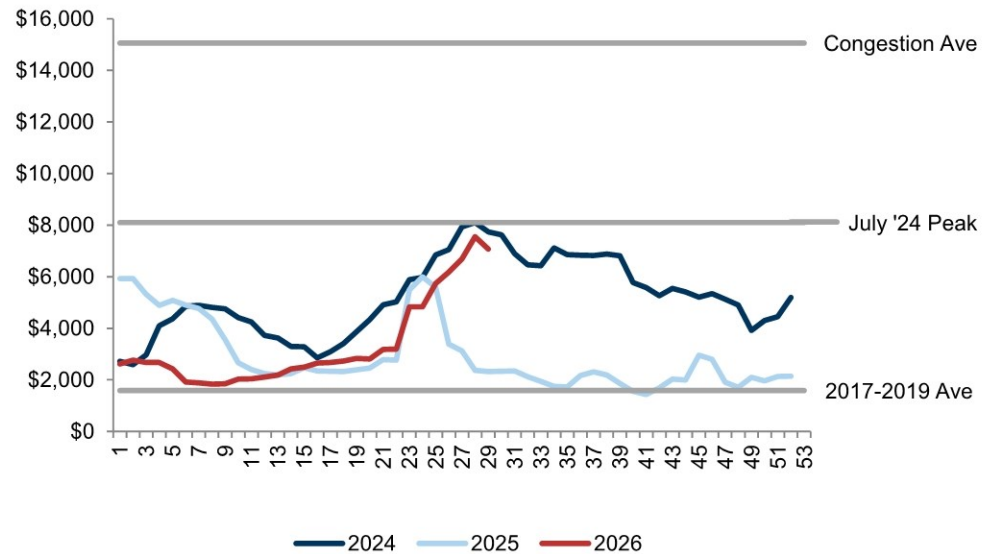


Weekly through 7/12/2026. Data compiled by our Asia Analysts, Herbert Lu, Simon Cheung and Dorothy Wong

Source: Ministry of Transport

- Ocean container rates from China/East Asia to the US West Coast were down -6% from last week and up +204% YoY in the most recent week. We anticipate some volatility over the coming weeks as global capacity shifts given ongoing geopolitical events, given potential surcharges, and considering peak season beginning earlier this year.

Exhibit 9: Ocean rates decreased -6% WoW after increasing +13% in the previous week
China/East Asia to the North American West Coast, \$/FEU

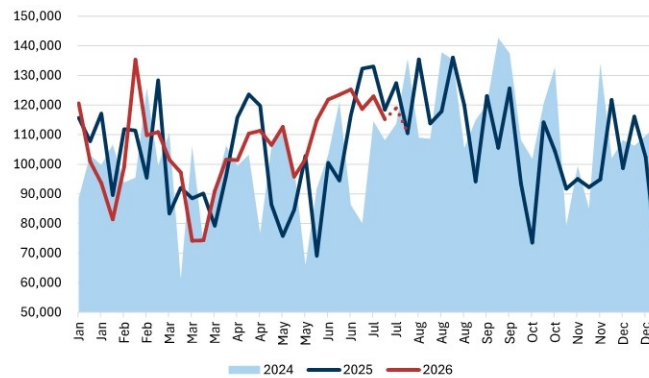


Weekly rate through 7/17/2026

Source: Freightos

- **Planned TEUs into the Port of LA in the most recent week were down -6% sequentially after -5%/+4% WoW moves in the prior two weeks. Looking ahead, this week's negative sequential move appears to increase next week to +3% before then decreasing to -7% two weeks out. YoY trends are expected to decline -7% YoY for TEUs next week and then remain unchanged two weeks out.**

Exhibit 10: Planned TEUs are expected to increase sequentially next week and decrease two weeks out
Planned TEUs into the Port of LA



Weekly data updated daily as of 7/17/2026 Port Optimizer data includes two week forward data for week ending 7/31

Source: Port Optimizer

Exhibit 11: Tracking volumes over the last four weeks and upcoming 2 weeks
Port Optimizer 6 Week Dashboard

Port Optimizer 6 Week Dashboard							
Date	6/19/2026	6/26/2026	7/3/2026	7/10/2026	7/17/2026	7/24/2026	7/31/2026
Week	24	25	26	27	28	29	30
TEUs	123,527	125,283	118,669	122,977	115,261	118,991	110,834
WoW	N/A	1.4%	-5.3%	3.6%	-6.3%	3.2%	-6.9%
2025 WoW	-6.0%	23.3%	13.6%	0.6%	-11.0%	7.6%	-13.3%
2026 YoY	30.7%	7.5%	-10.3%	-7.6%	-2.7%	-6.6%	0.3%
Vessels	22	23	23	22	23	21	21
WoW	N/A	4.5%	0.0%	-4.3%	4.5%	-8.7%	0.0%
2025 WoW	0.0%	17.6%	20.0%	8.3%	-7.7%	-12.5%	4.8%
2026 YoY	29.4%	15.0%	-4.2%	-15.4%	-4.2%	0.0%	-4.5%

Weekly data update as of 7/10/2026 Port Optimizer data includes two week forward data for week ending 7/24

Source: Port Optimizer

- WorldACD Weekly Cargo Trends Asia Pacific to North America weights and rates (as of 7/9; latest), two week over two week was -2% and -3% last week, after -1% and +1% in the prior week, respectively. The sequential weight movements are figures to watch to ascertain the need for faster cycle logistics. **We continue to monitor rate impact on global and regional rates from reduced air capacity in Gulf states in addition to increase in jet fuel pricing, noting the limited visibility on weekly rates, as well as recognizing the dynamic situation as some airports have limited reopening of flights.**

Exhibit 12: Trends for air cargo out of Asia Pacific to North America: weight and rate increased in the most recent week (-1% and +1% respectively)

WorldACD Last Two Weeks Compared with the Preceding Two Weeks, Asia Pacific to North America Weight and Rate

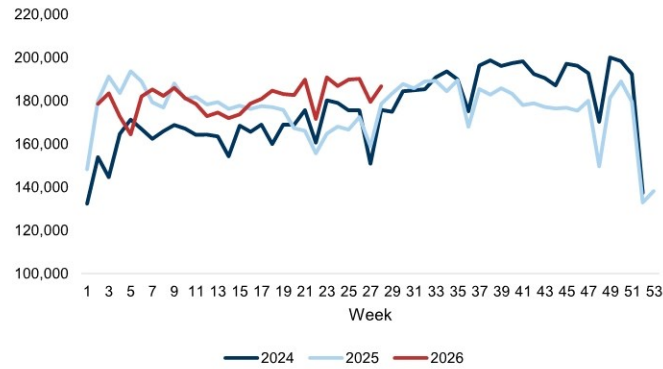


Weekly two week over two week change as of 7/9/2026

Source: WorldACD

- Intermodal traffic growth on the West Coast (UNP/BNSF) was +4% YoY in the most recent week, versus +13% last week.

Exhibit 13: West Coast intermodal carloads were +4% YoY versus +13% YoY last week
Intermodal Carloads on the West Coast



- Truckload spot rates ex-fuel on the West Coast from truckstop.com increased -6% w/w and +69% YoY in the most recent week.
- Truck load availability index on the West Coast was up +25% w/w and up +1% YoY.

Exhibit 14: Rates were +69% YoY last week on the West Coast
Truckload Spot Rates ex-fuel West Coast

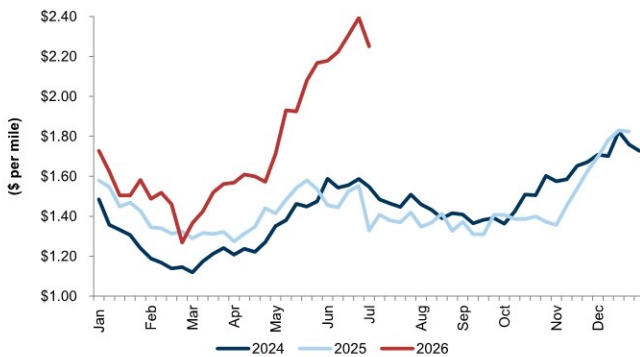
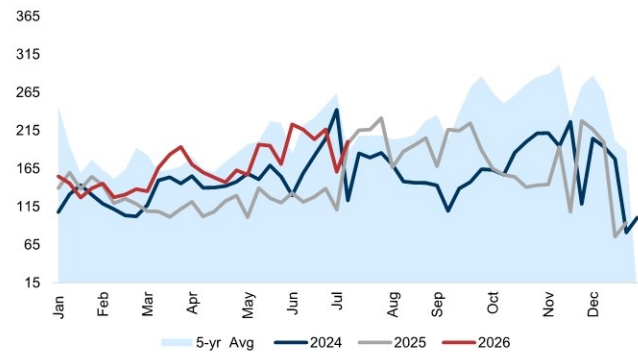


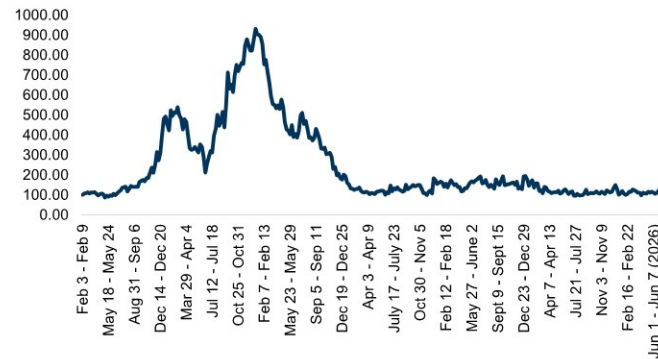
Exhibit 15: Truckload load availability was +1% YoY this past week on the West Coast
Truckload Load Availability Index on the West Coast



- Our Supply Chain Congestion Tracker stayed at '2' this past week as the bottleneck index was increased +12% w/w; overall fluidity levels are closer to the pre-Covid baseline.

Exhibit 16: Congestion remains fluid as per our supply chain congestion index, about in line with pre-Covid levels

GS Weekly Supply Chain Congestion Index, Feb 2020 - July 2026



Weekly data as of 7/5/2026

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Lagged Monthly Data

We include monthly data that we believe reflects the impact to freight flows from trade policy.

- Big Three (Ports of LA, Long Beach and Oakland) volumes were +30% YoY and up +2.5% sequentially from April to May—below historical seasonality of +12%.

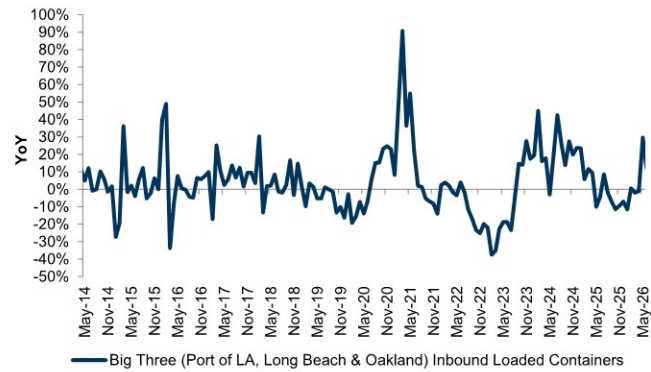
Exhibit 17: Volumes into the West Coast were up +2.5% in May from April, below historical seasonality

Big Three Volumes

May-2026	YoY%	Seq%	5-yr YoY% Avg	5-yr Seq% Avg
Port of Long Beach	40.0%	7.4%	-0.9%	12.1%
Port of LA	26.2%	-2.3%	4.2%	12.9%
Port of Oakland	5.7%	6.2%	2.6%	8.7%
Big Three Total	29.6%	2.5%	1.8%	12.0%

Source: Port of Los Angeles, Port of Long Beach, Port of Oakland

Exhibit 18: Imports into the West Coast were +30% YoY in May
Big Three Volumes YoY



Source: Port of Los Angeles, Port of Long Beach, Port of Oakland

- Drewry air rates from Shanghai to LA were down -2% MoM in May after being up +25% in April. Depending on the development of geopolitical events, we could see a subsequent increase of rates in June as air capacity gets tied up in addition to the rise in jet fuel prices—to be determined.

Exhibit 19: May rates were down -2% from April
Drewry Air Rates Shanghai to LA

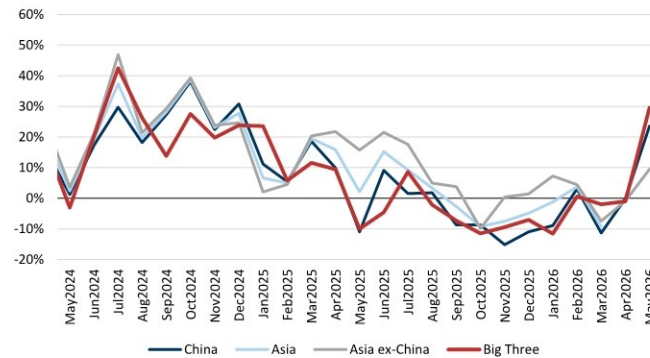


Source: Drewry

- **Big Three YoY v. Monthly YoY growth of Bloomberg reported TEUs from China, Asia and Asia ex-China to US shows a strong relationship.**

Exhibit 20: Big Three growth tends to follow TEU growth out of Asia to the US

Big Three YoY v. China/Asia/Asia ex-China to US TEU Monthly YoY



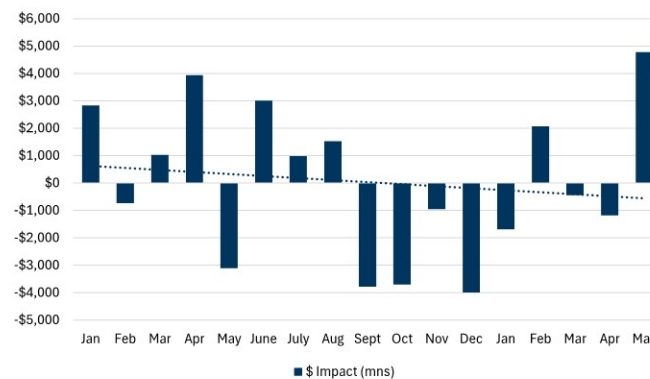
China and Asia TEU YoY data through 5/26

Source: Bloomberg, Port of Los Angeles, Port of Long Beach, Port of Oakland

- **We estimate that imports could have been up +\$4.8bn YoY in May following April's estimated YoY decrease of ~-\$1.2bn (Exhibit 21). This follows the prior month declines September through January.**

- We leverage a similar analysis from the Longshoreman strike last October (see our [longshoreman impact note](#)). According to the Bureau of Transportation Statistics, Ocean trade was about \$2.3tn in trade in 2022. The top 25 ports in the U.S. moved 44mn loaded TEUs in 2022, meaning that each loaded container (TEU) on average in 2022 had a value of ~\$52,000. Growing this by inflation of ~3% for the last three years implied value per container of ~\$57,000. Multiplying the YoY change in TEUs with the value/TEU, we estimate the monthly imported value change YoY.

Exhibit 21: We estimate that May levels were higher YoY
Implied Trade Value Change YoY Based on YoY TEU Change and Estimated Value/TEU



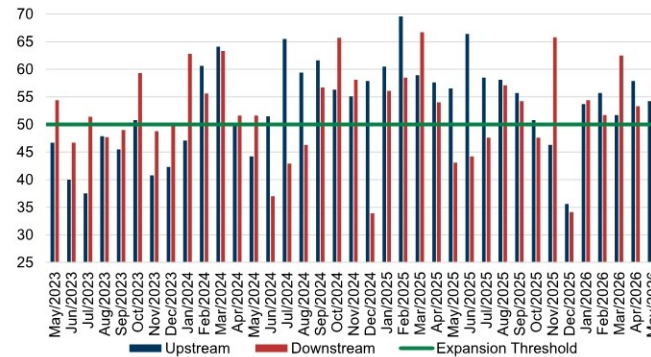
Source: Port Optimizer, US Bureau of Transportation Statistics (BTS), Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

■ Logistics Managers Index Inventory Level Expansion

- May upstream (B2B) inventories expanded slower at 54.2 vs 57.9 in April.
- May downstream (Retail) inventories expanded faster at 57.8 after 53.3 in April.

Exhibit 22: LMI has shown upstream and downstream expansion

Logistics Manager Index—Inventory Level Expansion, Upstream (B2B) vs Downstream (Retail) Respondents



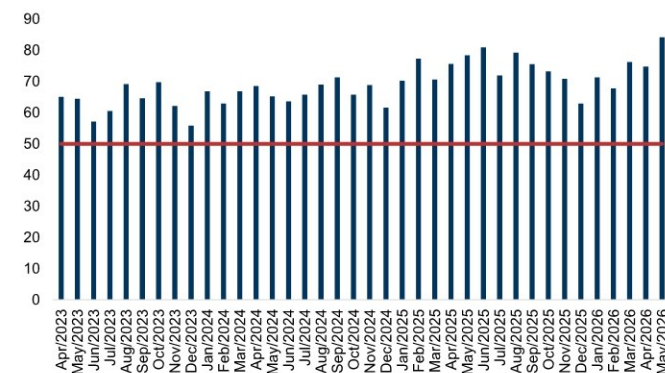
Source: Logistics Managers Index

■ Logistics Managers Index Inventory Cost Index

- Inventory cost index was 84.1 in May vs 74.7 in April, reflecting inventory costs expanding faster.

Exhibit 23: Inventory costs expanded faster in May vs April

LMI Inventory Cost Index

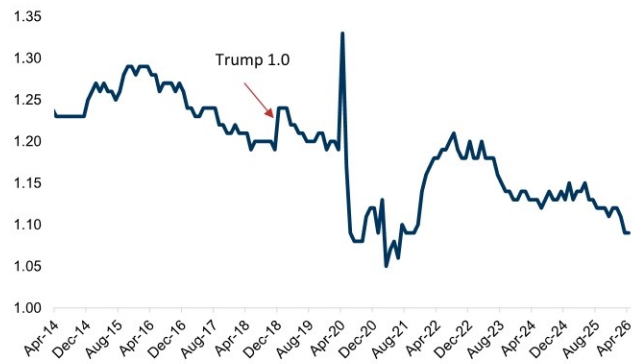


Source: Logistics Managers Index

- Inventory to sales for retailers/manufacturers/wholesalers were 1.09/1.50/1.19 for April which is lower versus March at 1.09/1.51/1.21.

Exhibit 24: Inventory to sales have not shown an increase like in Trump 1.0...

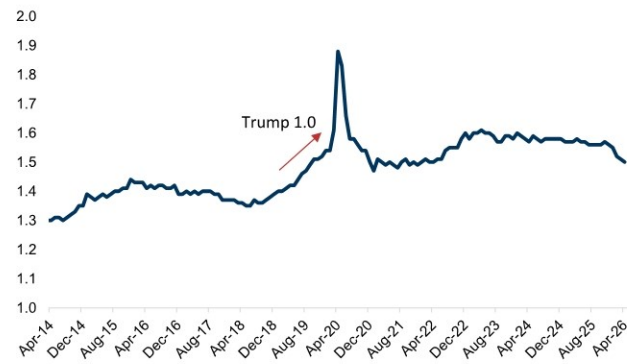
Inventory to Sales Ratio: Retailers ex Motor Vehicle and Parts Dealers



Source: Census Bureau

Exhibit 25: ...nor for manufacturers...

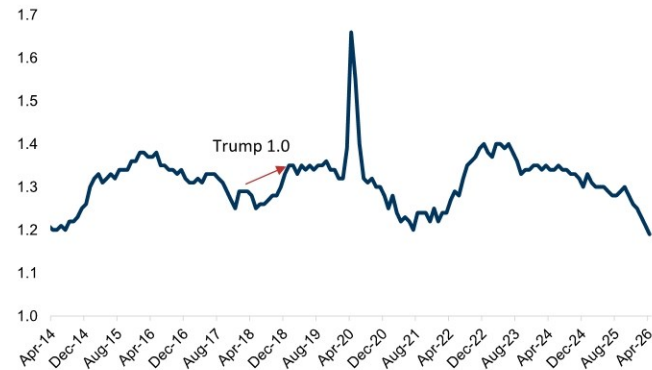
Inventory to Sales Manufacturers



Source: Census Bureau

Exhibit 26: ...while wholesalers were also unchanged

Inventory to Sales Wholesalers



Source: Census Bureau

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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Unless otherwise stated, the individuals listed on the cover page of this report are analysts in Goldman Sachs' Global Investment Research division.

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Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

Financial Returns and Multiple use the Goldman Sachs analyst forecasts at the fiscal year-end at least three quarters in the future. Growth uses inputs for the fiscal year at least seven quarters in the future compared with the year at least three quarters in the future (on a per-share basis for all metrics).

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